

**PMSCS 670**

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**Software Testing**

**Graph Coverage**

**Lecture 7**

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# Ch. 7 : Graph Coverage

## Four Structures for Modeling Software

Input Space

Graphs

Logic

Syntax

Applied  
to

Applied  
to

Applied  
to

Source

FSMs

Specs

DNF

Source

Specs

Design

Use cases

Source

Models

Integ

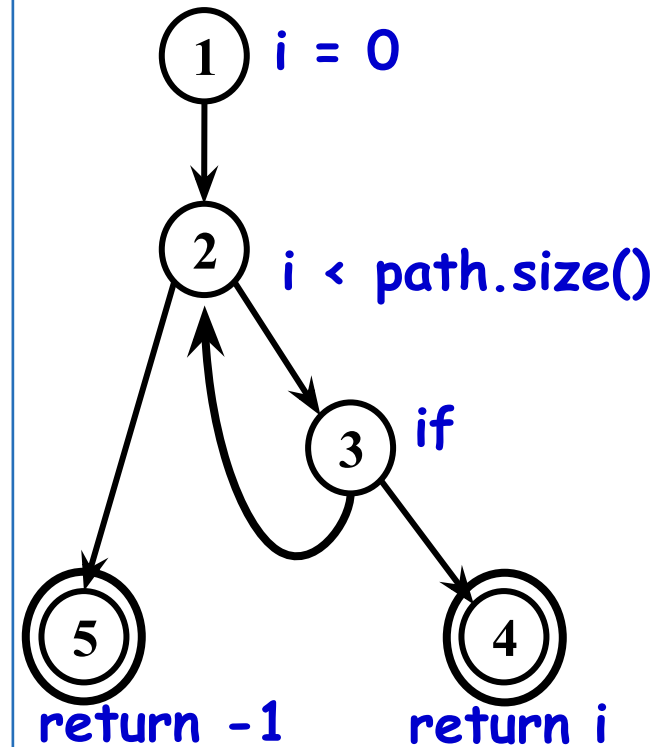
Input

# Small Illustrative Example

## Software Artifact : Java Method

```
/**
 * Return index of node n at the
 * first position it appears,
 * -1 if it is not present
 */
public int indexOf (Node n)
{
    for (int i=0; i < path.size(); i++)
        if (path.get(i).equals(n))
            return i;
    return -1;
}
```

## Control Flow Graph

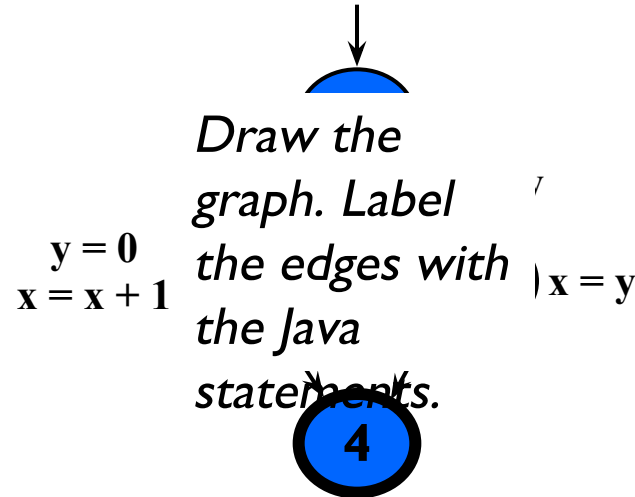


# Control Flow Graphs

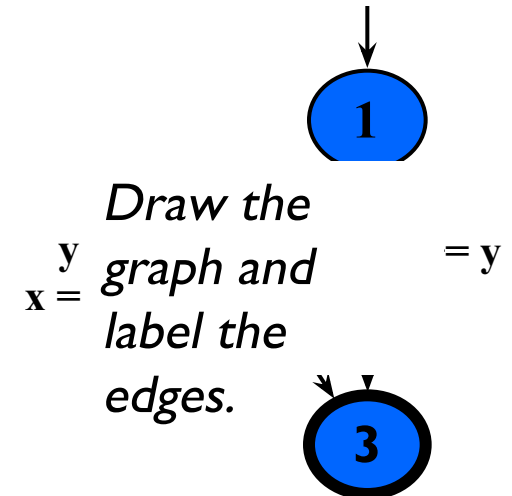
- A **CFG** models all executions of a method by describing control structures
- **Nodes** : Statements or sequences of statements (basic blocks)
- **Edges** : Transfers of control
- **Basic Block** : A sequence of statements such that if the first statement is executed, all statements will be (no branches)
- CFGs are sometimes annotated with extra information
  - branch predicates
  - defs
  - uses
- Rules for translating statements into graphs ...

# CFG : The if Statement

```
if (x < y)
{
    y = 0;
    x = x + 1;
}
else
{
    x = y;
}
```

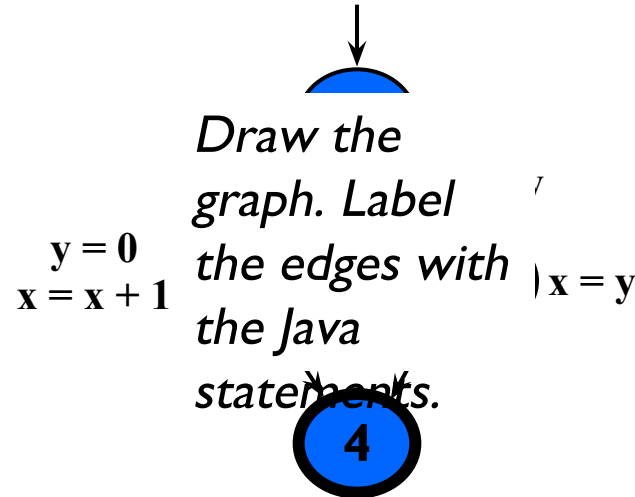


```
if (x < y)
{
    y = 0;
    x = x + 1;
}
```

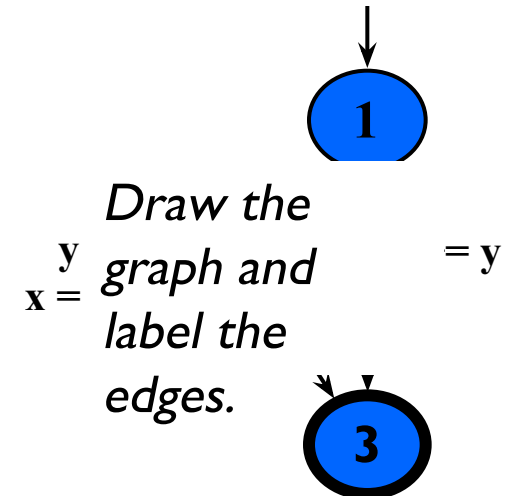


# CFG : The if Statement

```
if (x < y)
{
    y = 0;
    x = x + 1;
}
else
{
    x = y;
}
```



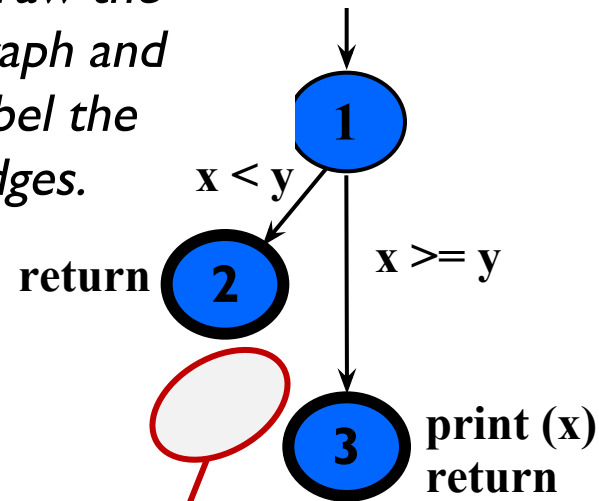
```
if (x < y)
{
    y = 0;
    x = x + 1;
}
```



# CFG : The if-Return Statement

```
if (x < y)
{
    return;
}
print (x);
return;
```

*Draw the graph and label the edges.*



**No edge from node 2 to 3.  
The return nodes must be distinct.**

# Loops

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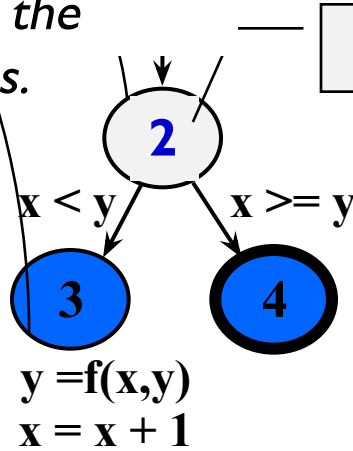
- Loops require “*extra*” nodes to be added
- Nodes that **do not** represent statements or basic blocks



# CFG : while and for Loops

```
x = 0;  
while (x < y)  
{  
    y = f(x, y);  
    x = x + 1;  
}
```

Draw the  
graph and  
label the  
edges.

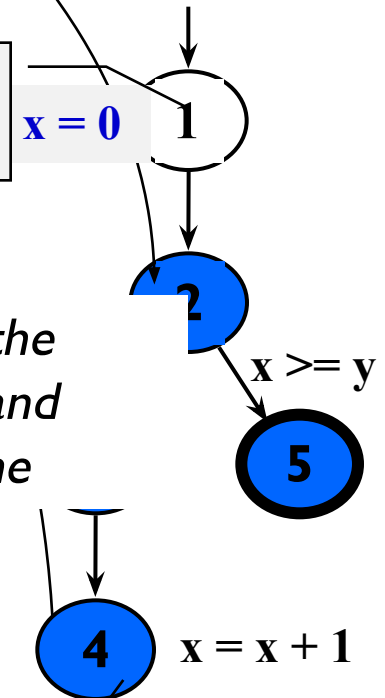


**dummy node**

**implicitly  
initializes loop**

```
for (x = 0; x < y; x++)  
{  
    y = f(x, y);  
}
```

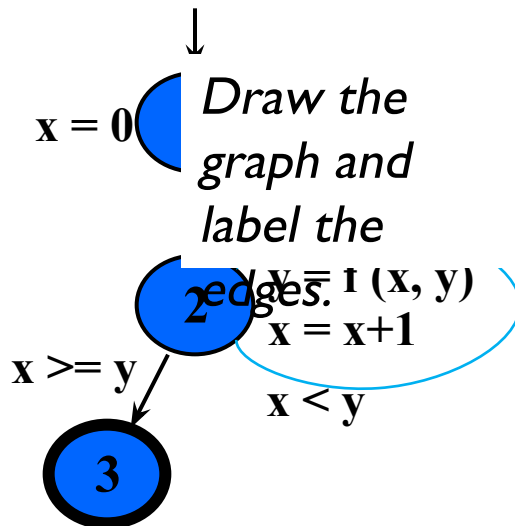
Draw the  
graph and  
label the  
edges.



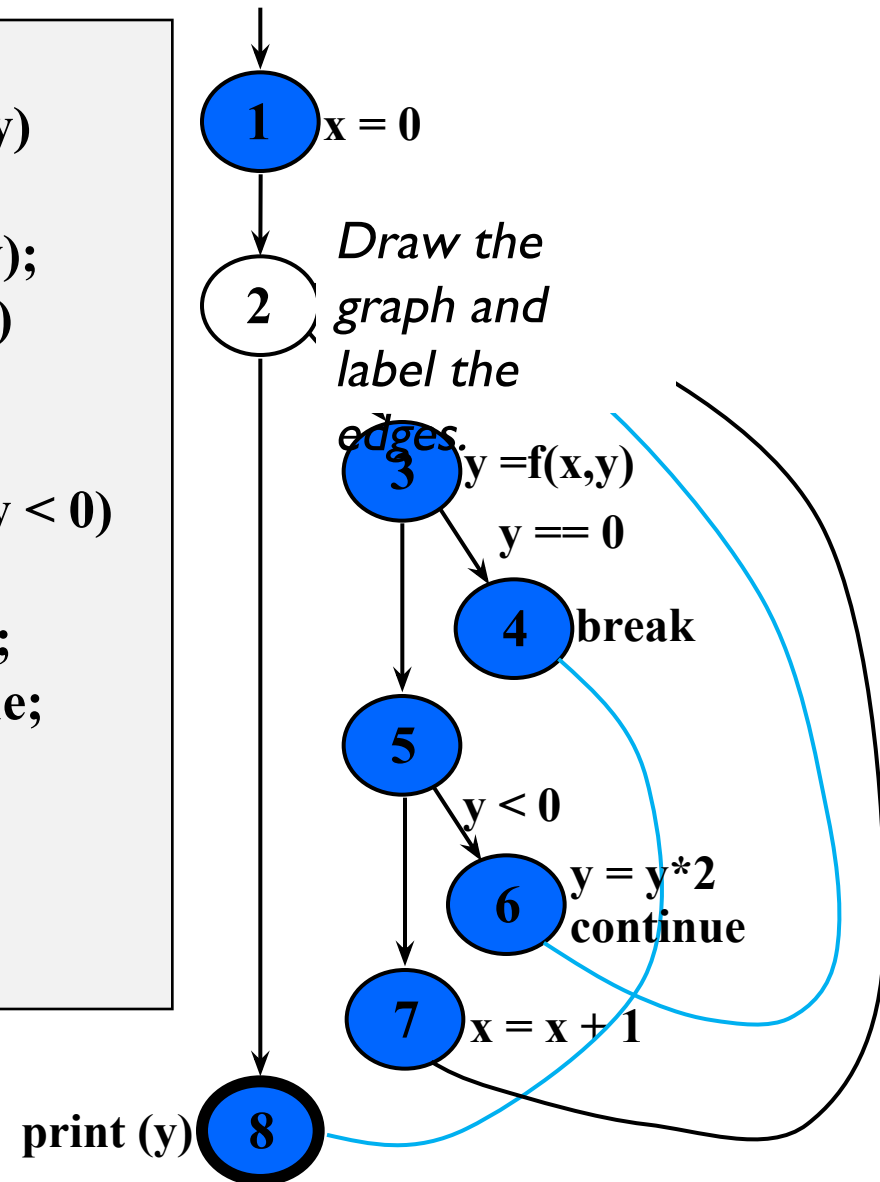
**implicitly  
increments loop**

# CFG : do Loop, break and continue

```
x = 0;
do
{
  y = f(x, y);
  x = x + 1;
} while (x < y);
println (y)
```



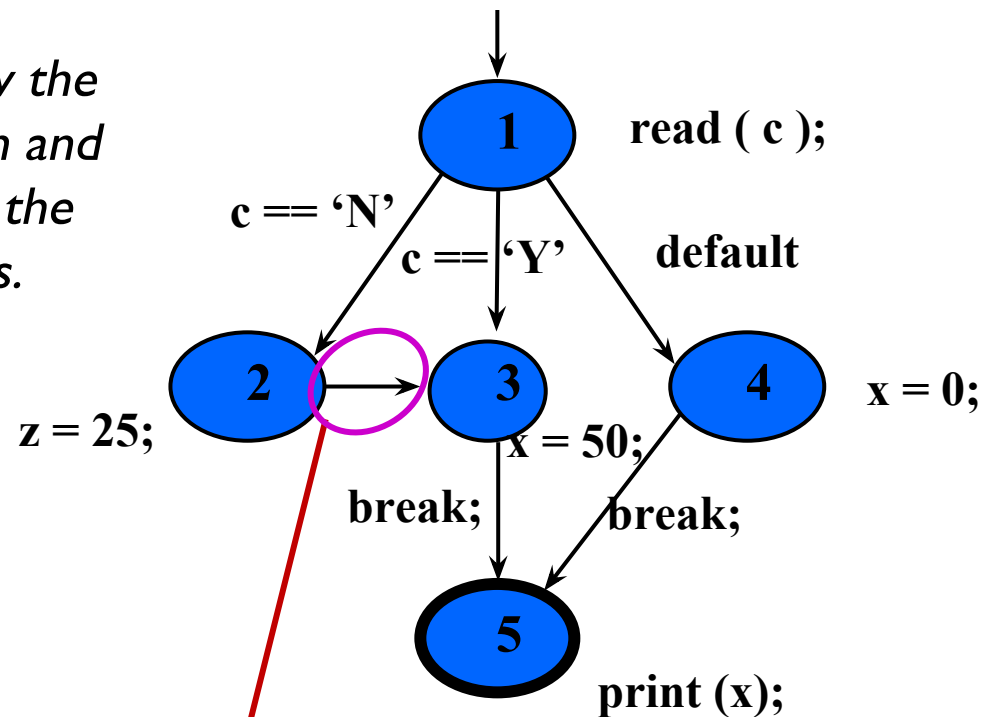
```
x = 0;
while (x < y)
{
  y = f(x, y);
  if (y == 0)
  {
    break;
  } else if (y < 0)
  {
    y = y*2;
    continue;
  }
  x = x + 1;
}
print (y);
```



# CFG : The case (switch) Structure

```
read ( c );  
switch ( c )  
{  
  case 'N':  
    z = 25;  
  case 'Y':  
    x = 50;  
    break;  
  default:  
    x = 0;  
    break;  
}  
print (x);
```

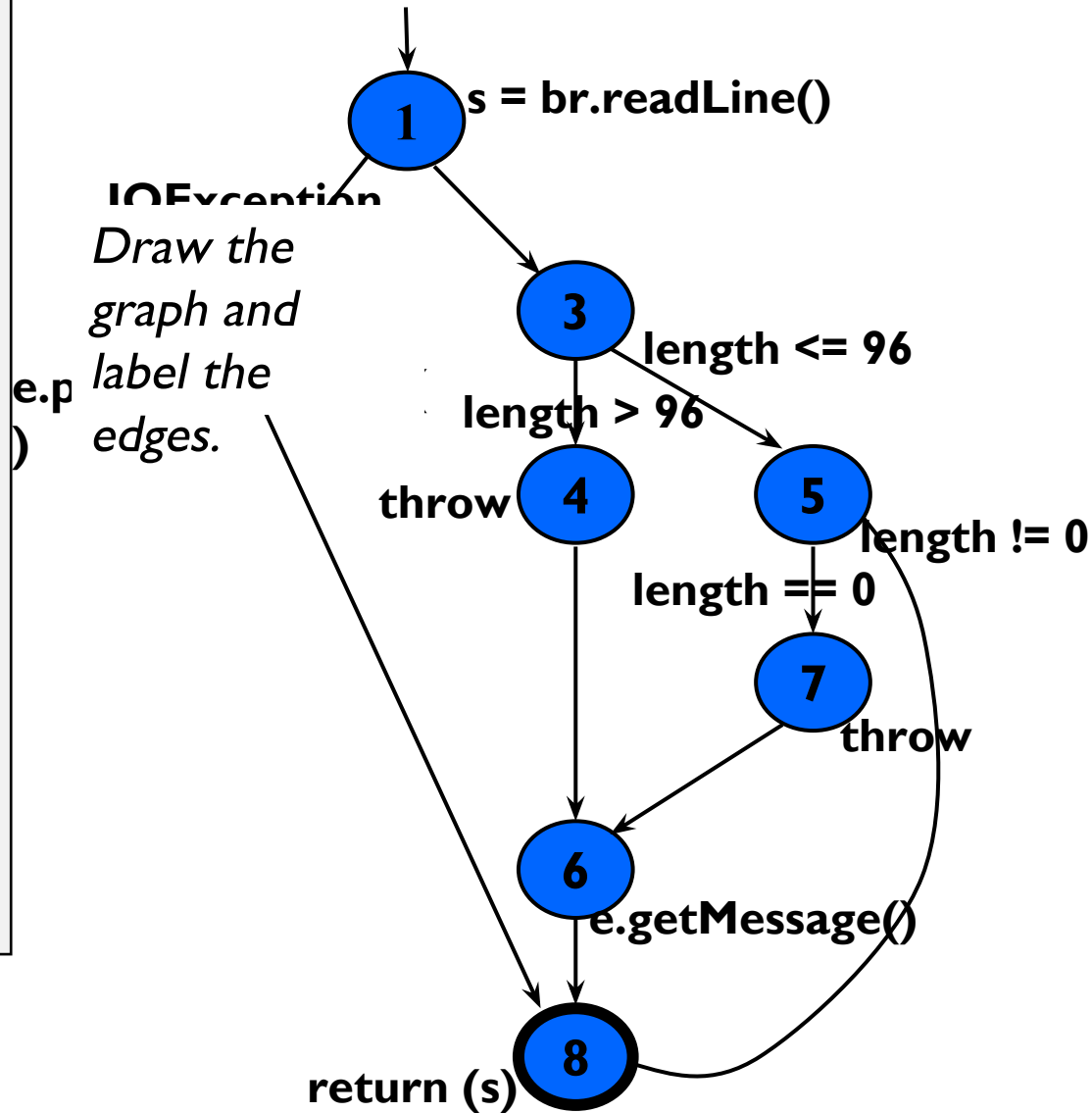
*Draw the graph and label the edges.*



**Cases without breaks fall through to the next case**

# CFG : Exceptions (try-catch)

```
try
{
    s = br.readLine();
    if (s.length() > 96)
        throw new Exception
            ("too long");
    if (s.length() == 0)
        throw new Exception
            ("too short");
} (catch IOException e) {
    e.printStackTrace();
} (catch Exception e) {
    e.getMessage();
}
return (s);
```



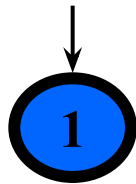
# Covering Graphs (7.1)

- Graphs are the most **commonly** used structure for testing
- Graphs can come from **many sources**
  - Control flow graphs
  - Design structure
  - FSMs and statecharts
  - Use cases
- Tests usually are intended to “**cover**” the graph in some way

# Definition of a Graph

- Any Graph  $G(N, N_0, N_f, E)$ , can be defined as-
  - A set  $N$  of **nodes**,  $N$  is **not empty**
  - A set  $N_0$  of **initial nodes**,  $N_0$  is **not empty** and  $N_0 \subseteq N$
  - A set  $N_f$  of **final nodes**,  $N_f$  is **not empty** and  $N_f \subseteq N$
  - A set  $E$  of **edges**, each edge from one node to another  $(n_i, n_j)$ , where  $i$  is **predecessor**,  $j$  is **successor**  $E \subseteq N \times N$

Is this a  
graph?



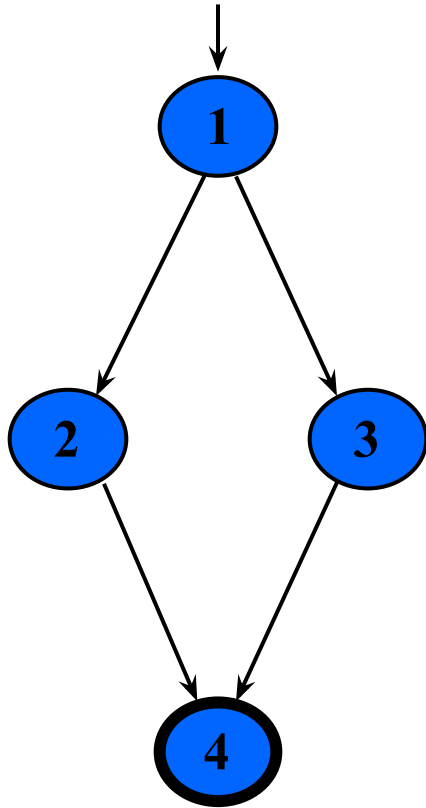
$$N_0 = \{ 1 \}$$

$$N_f = \{ 1 \}$$

$$E = \{ \}$$



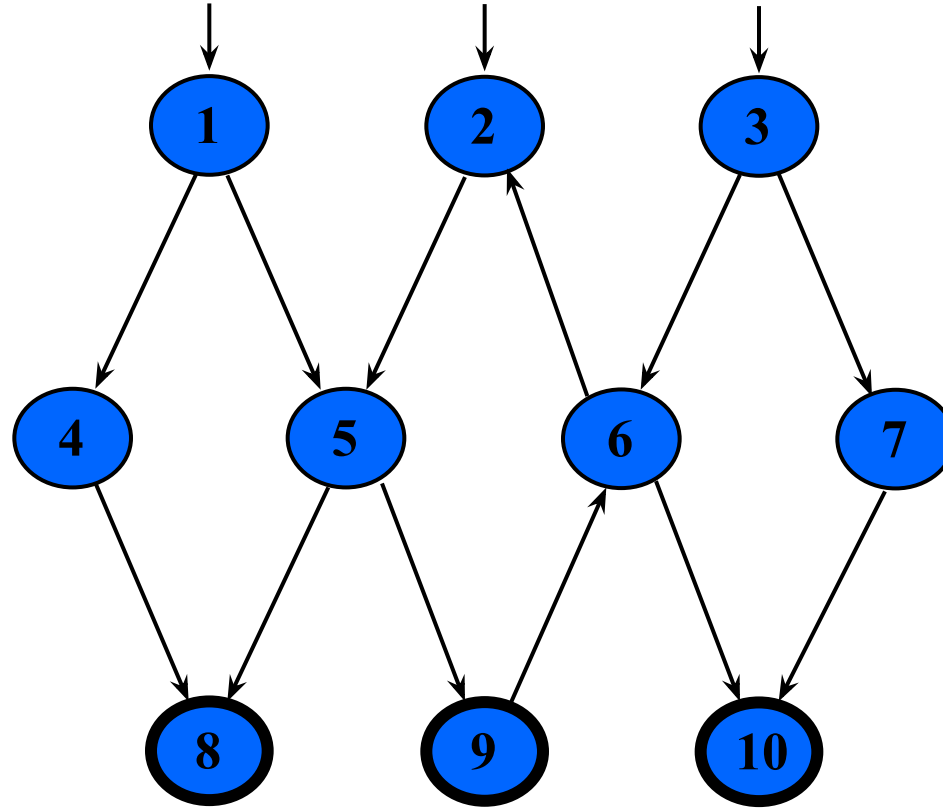
# Example Graphs



$$N_0 = \{ 1 \}$$

$$N_f = \{ 4 \}$$

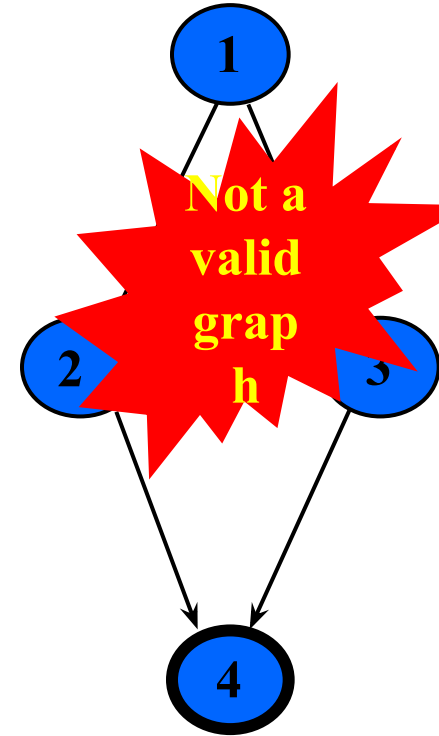
$$E = \{ (1,2), (1,3), (2,4), (3,4) \}$$



$$N_0 = \{ 1, 2, 3 \}$$

$$N_f = \{ 8, 9, 10 \}$$

$$E = \{ (1,4), (1,5), (2,5), (3,6), (3,7), (4,8), (5,8), (5,9), (6,2), (6,10), (7,10), (9,6) \}$$



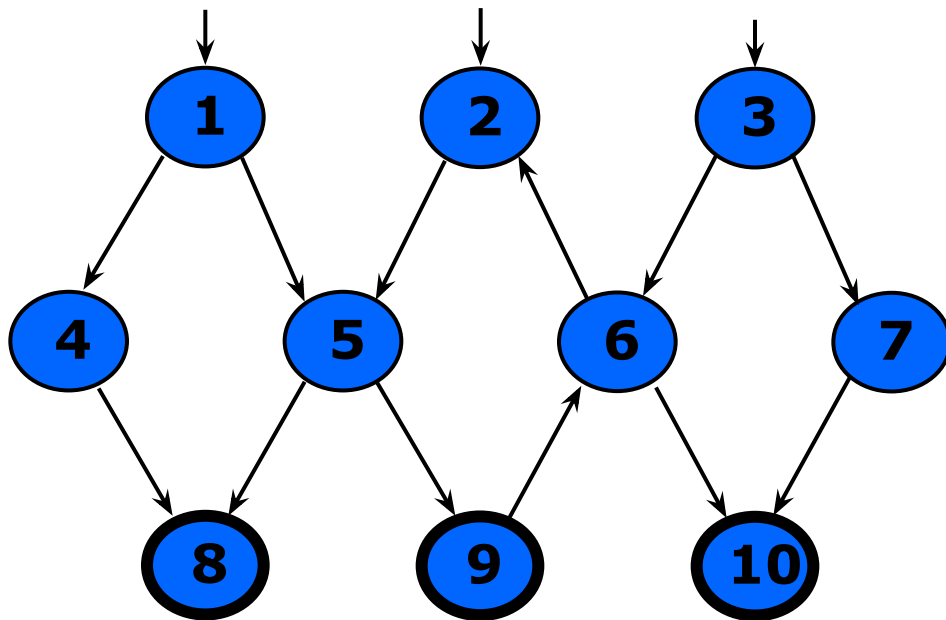
$$N_0 = \{ \}$$

$$N_f = \{ 4 \}$$

$$E = \{ (1,2), (1,3), (2,4), (3,4) \}$$

# Paths in Graphs

- **Path** : A sequence of nodes –  $[n_1, n_2, \dots, n_M]$ 
  - Each pair of nodes is an edge
- **Length** : The number of edges
  - A single node is a path of length 0
- **Subpath** : A subsequence of nodes in  $p$  is a subpath of  $p$
- **Reach** ( $n$ ) : Subgraph that can be reached from  $n$



## A Few Paths

[ 1, 4, 8 ]

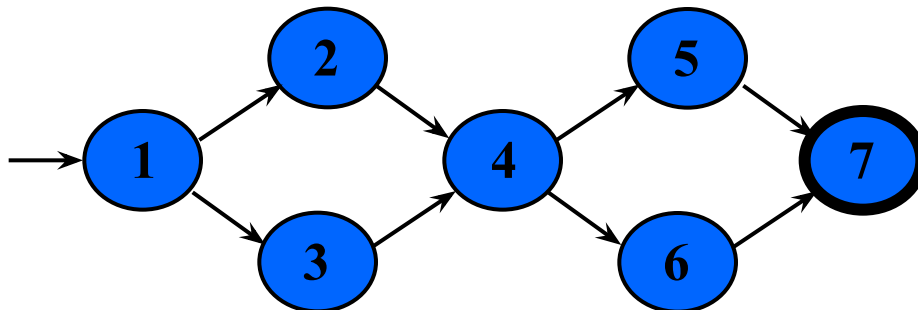
[ 2, 5, 9, 6, 2 ]

[ 3, 7, 10 ]



# Test Paths and SESEs

- **Test Path** : A path that **starts at an initial node** and **ends at a final node**
- Test paths represent execution of test cases
  - Some test paths can be executed by many tests
  - Some test paths cannot be executed by any tests
- **SESE graphs** : All test paths start at a single node and end at another node
  - Single-entry, single-exit
  - N0 and Nf have exactly one node



## Double-diamond graph

### Four test paths

[1, 2, 4, 5, 7]

[1, 2, 4, 6, 7]

[1, 3, 4, 5, 7]

[1, 3, 4, 6, 7]

# Visiting and Touring

- **Visit** : A test path  $p$  visits node  $n$  if  $n$  is in  $p$   
A test path  $p$  visits edge  $e$  if  $e$  is in  $p$
- **Tour** : A test path  $p$  tours subpath  $q$  if  $q$  is a subpath of  $p$

**Test path [ 1, 2, 4, 5, 7 ]**

**Visits nodes ? 1, 2, 4, 5, 7**

**Visits edges ? (1,2), (2,4), (4, 5), (5, 7)**

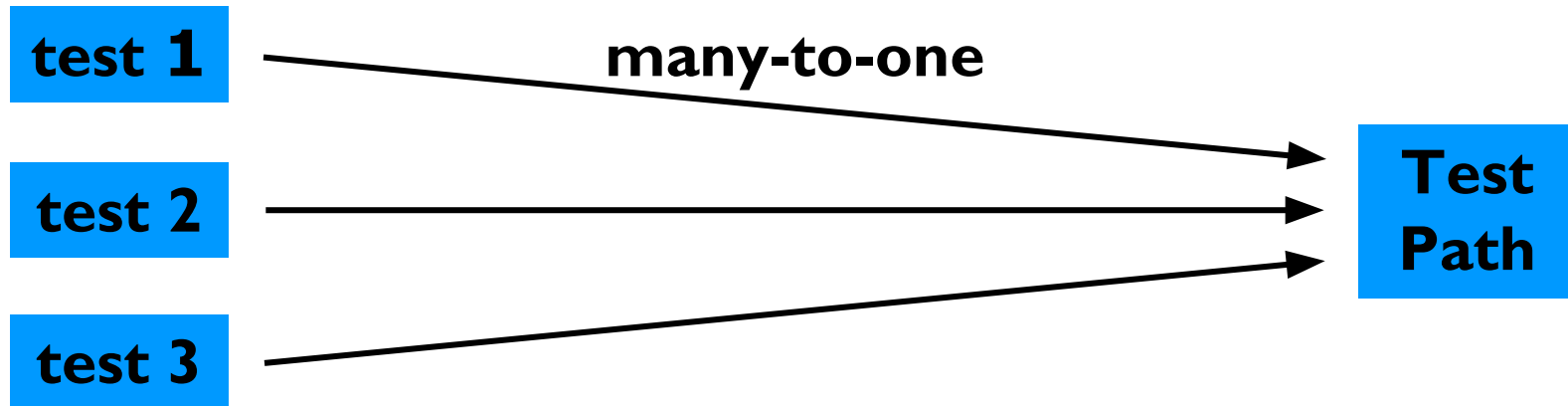
**Tours subpaths ? [1,2,4], [2,4,5], [4,5,7], [1,2,4,5],  
[2,4,5,7], [1,2,4,5,7]**

**(Also, each edge is technically a subpath )**

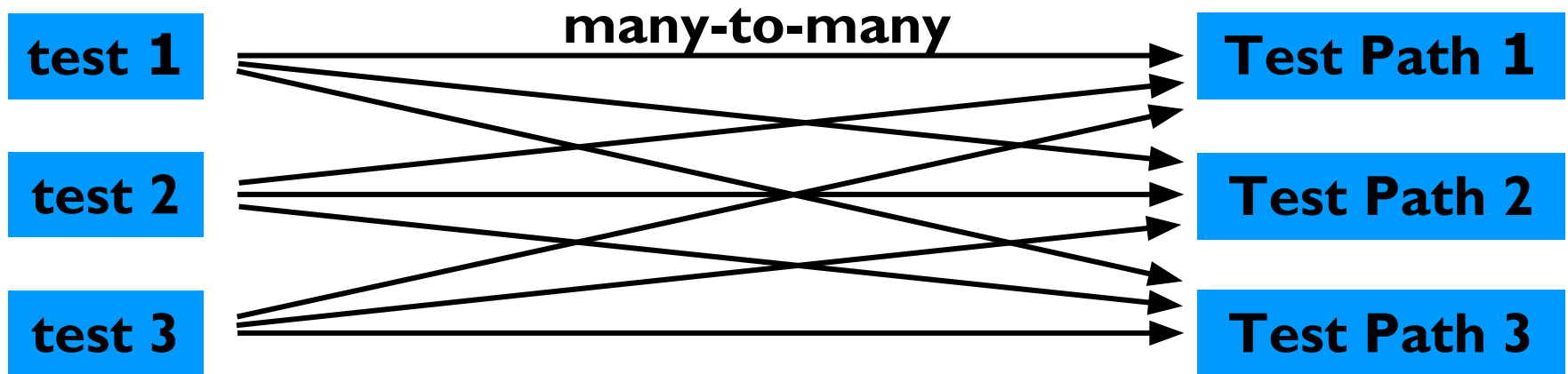
# Tests and Test Paths

- $\text{path}(t)$  : The test path executed by test  $t$
- $\text{path}(T)$  : The **set of test paths** executed by the set of tests  $T$
- Each test executes **one and only one** test path
  - Complete execution from a start node to an final node
- A location in a graph (node or edge) can be **reached** from another location if there is a sequence of edges from the first location to the second
  - *Syntactic reach* : A subpath exists in the graph
  - *Semantic reach* : A test exists that can execute that subpath

# Tests and Test Paths



**Deterministic software-test always executes the same test path**



**Non-deterministic software-the same test can execute different test paths**

# Testing and Covering Graphs (7.2)

- We use graphs in testing as follows :
  - Develop a model of the software as a graph
  - **Require tests to** visit or tour specific sets of nodes, edges or subpaths
- **Test Requirements (TR)** : Describe properties of test paths
- **Test Criterion** : Rules that define test requirements
- **Satisfaction** : *Given a set  $TR$  of test requirements for a criterion  $C$ , a set of tests  $T$  satisfies  $C$  on a graph if and only if for every test requirement in  $TR$ , there is a test path in  $path(T)$  that meets the test requirement*
- **Structural Coverage Criteria** : Defined on a graph just in terms of nodes and edges
- **Data Flow Coverage Criteria** : Requires a graph to be annotated with references to variables

# Node and Edge Coverage

- The first (and simplest) two criteria require that each node and edge in a graph be executed

**Node Coverage (NC) :** Test set  $T$  satisfies node coverage on graph  $G$  iff for every syntactically reachable node  $n$  in  $N$ , there is some path  $p$  in  $path(T)$  such that  $p$  visits  $n$ .

- This statement is a bit cumbersome, so we abbreviate it in terms of the set of test requirements

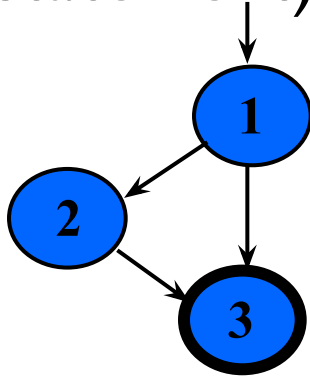
**Node Coverage (NC) :** TR contains each reachable node in  $G$ .

# Node and Edge Coverage

- Edge coverage is slightly stronger than node coverage

**Edge Coverage (EC) : TR contains each reachable path of length up to 1, inclusive, in G.**

- The phrase “*length up to 1*” allows for graphs with one node and no edges
- NC and EC are only different when there is an edge and another subpath between a pair of nodes (as in an “if-else” statement)



**Node Coverage : ?TR = { 1, 2, 3 }**

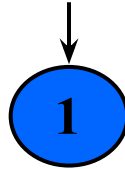
**Test Path = [ 1, 2, 3 ]**

**Edge Coverage : ? TR = { (1, 2), (1, 3), (2, 3) }**

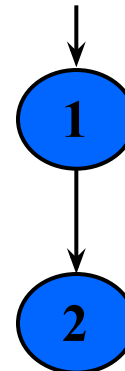
**Test Paths = [ 1, 2, 3 ]  
[ 1, 3 ]**

# Paths of Length 1 and 0

- A graph with **only one node** will not have any edges



- It may seem trivial, but formally, Edge Coverage needs to require Node Coverage on this graph
- Otherwise, Edge Coverage will not subsume Node Coverage
  - So we define “**length up to 1**” instead of simply “length 1”
- We have the same issue with graphs that only have **one edge** – for Edge-Pair Coverage ...



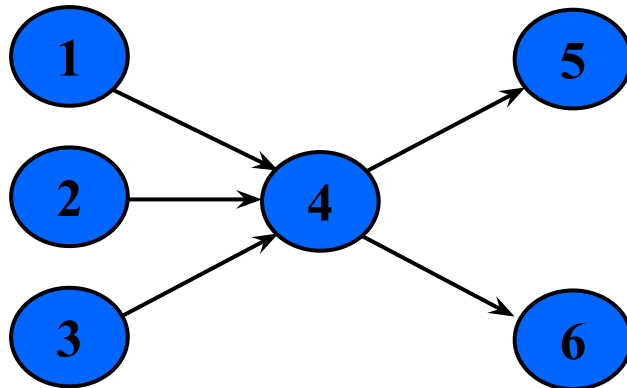


# Covering Multiple Edges

- Edge-pair coverage requires pairs of edges, or subpaths of length 2

**Edge-Pair Coverage (EPC) : TR contains each reachable path of length up to 2, inclusive, in G.**

- The phrase “length up to 2” is used to include graphs that have less than 2 edges



**Edge-Pair Coverage : ?**

**TR = { [1,4,5], [1,4,6], [2,4,5], [2,4,6], [3,4,5], [3,4,6] }**

- The logical extension is to require **all paths** ...

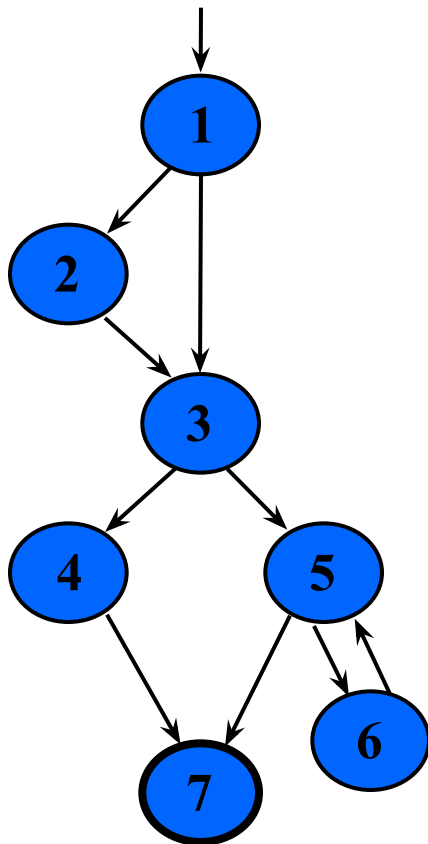
# Covering Multiple Edges

**Complete Path Coverage (CPC) : TR contains all paths in G.**

Unfortunately, this is **impossible** if the graph has a loop, so a weak compromise makes the tester decide which paths:

**Specified Path Coverage (SPC) : TR contains a set  $S$  of test paths, where  $S$  is supplied as a parameter.**

# Structural Coverage Example



## Node Coverage

**TR** = { 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7 }

**Test Paths:** [ 1, 2, 3, 4, 7 ] [ 1, 2, 3, 5, 6, 5, 7 ]

*Write down  
the TRs and  
Test Paths  
for these  
criteria*

## Edge Coverage

**TR** = { (1,2), (1,3), (2,3), (3,4), (3,5), (4,7), (5,6), (6,5), (5,7) }

**Test Paths:** [ 1, 2, 3, 4, 7 ] [ 1, 3, 5, 6, 5, 7 ]

## Edge-Pair Coverage

**TR** = { [1,2,3], [1,3,4], [1,3,5], [2,3,4], [2,3,5], [3,4,7], [3,5,6], [3,5,7], [5,6,5], [6,5,6], [6,5,7] }

**Test Paths:** [ 1, 2, 3, 4, 7 ] [ 1, 2, 3, 5, 7 ] [ 1, 3, 4, 7 ]  
[ 1, 3, 5, 6, 5, 6, 5, 7 ]

## Complete Path Coverage

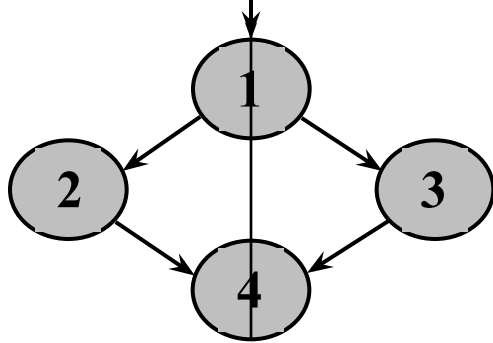
**Test Paths:** [ 1, 2, 3, 4, 7 ] [ 1, 2, 3, 5, 7 ] [ 1, 2, 3, 5, 6, 5, 7 ]  
[ 1, 2, 3, 5, 6, 5, 6, 5, 7 ] [ 1, 2, 3, 5, 6, 5, 6, 5, 6, 5, 7 ] ...

# Handling Loops in Graphs

- If a graph contains a loop, it has an **infinite** number of paths
- Thus, CPC is **not feasible**
- SPC is **not satisfactory** because the results are **subjective** and vary with the tester
- Attempts to “deal with” **loops**:
  - **1970s** : Execute cycles once ([4, 5, 4] in previous example, informal)
  - **1980s** : Execute each loop, exactly once (formalized)
  - **1990s** : Execute loops 0 times, once, more than once (informal description)
  - **2000s** : Prime paths (touring, sidetrips, and detours)

# Simple Paths and Prime Paths

- **Simple Path** : A path from node  $n_i$  to  $n_j$  is simple if *no node appears more than once*, except possibly the first and last nodes are the same
  - No internal loops
  - A loop is a simple path
- **Prime Path** : A *simple path that does not appear as a proper subpath* of any other simple path



**Simple Paths** : [1,2,4,1], [1,3,4,1], [2,4,1,2], [2,4,1,3], [3,4,1,2], [3,4,1,3], [4,1,2,4], [4,1,3,4], [1,2,4], [1,3,4], [2,4,1], [3,4,1], [4,1], [4,1], [1], [2], [3], [4]

Write down the simple and prime paths for this graph

**Prime Paths** : [2,4,1], [3,4,1], [1,2,4,1], [3,4,1,2], [4,1,3,4], [4,1,2,4], [3,4,1,3]

# Prime Path Coverage

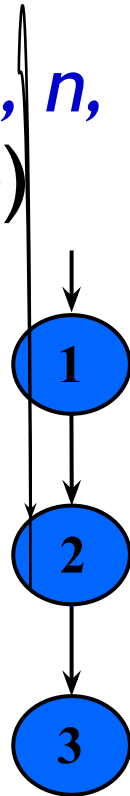
- A simple, elegant and finite criterion that requires **loops** to be executed as well as skipped

**Prime Path Coverage (PPC) : TR contains each prime path in G.**

- Will tour all paths of length 0, 1, ...
- That is, it **subsumes** node and edge coverage
- PPC almost, but **not quite**, subsumes **EPC** ...

# PPC Does Not Subsume EPC

- If a node  $n$  has an edge to itself (*self edge*), **EPC** requires  $[n, n, m]$  and  $[m, n, n]$
- $[n, n, m]$  is not prime
- Neither  $[n, n, m]$  nor  $[m, n, n]$  are simple paths (not prime)



**EPC Requirements : ?**

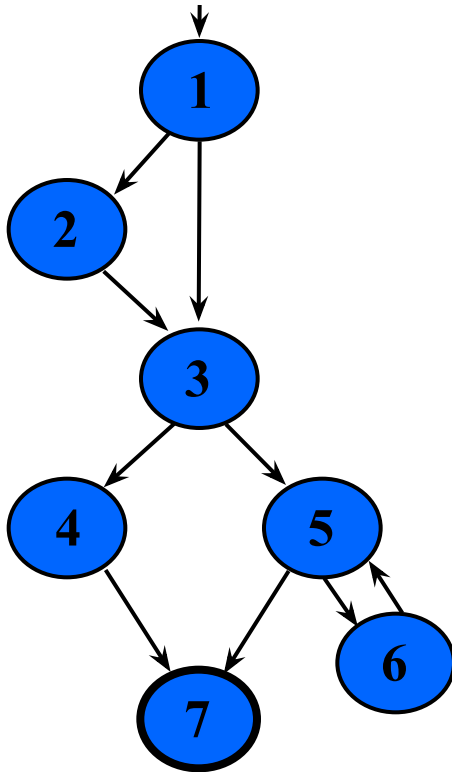
**TR = { [1,2,3], [1,2,2], [2,2,3], [2,2,2] }**

**PPC Requirements : ?**

**TR = { [1,2,3], [2,2] }**

# Prime Path Example

- The previous example has 38 **simple** paths
- Only **nine prime paths**



## Prime Paths

[1, 2, 3, 4, 7]

Write down  
all 9 prime

paths [3, 4, 7]

[1, 3, 5, 7]

[1, 3, 5, 6]

[6, 5, 7]

[6, 5, 6]

[5, 6, 5]

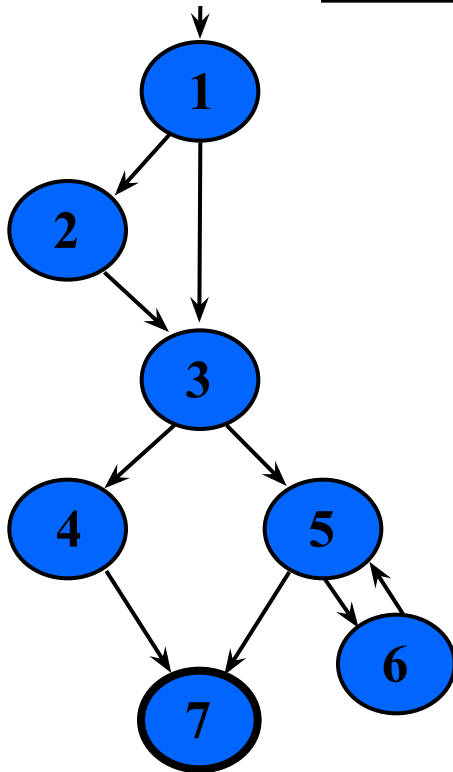
Execute  
loop 0 times

Execute  
loop once

Execute loop  
more than once



# Simple & Prime Path Example



Simple  
paths

Len 0

[1]

Write  
paths of  
length 0

[2]

[6]

[7] !

Len 1

[1, 2]

[1, 3]

Write  
paths of  
length 1

[1, 4] !

[5, 7] !

[5, 6]

[6, 5]

Len 2

[1, 2, 3]

[1, 3, 4]

[1, 2, 5]

Write  
paths of  
length 2

[3, 5, 7] !

[3, 5, 6]

[5, 6, 5] \*

[6, 5, 7] !

[6, 5, 6] \*

Len 3

[1, 2, 3, 4]

[1, 2, 3, 5]

Write

paths of  
length 3

[2, 3, 4, 7] !

[2, 3, 5, 6]

[2, 3, 5, 7] !

means  
cycles

Len 4

[1, 2, 3, 4, 7] !

[1, 2, 3, 5, 6] !

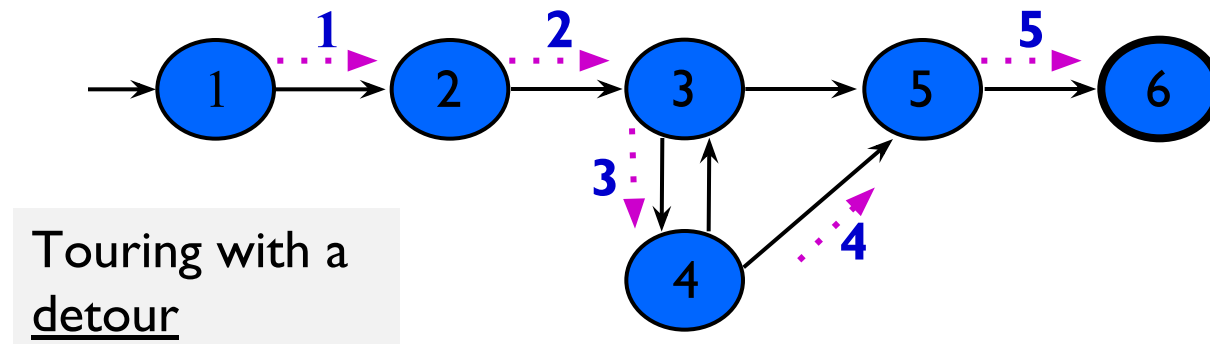
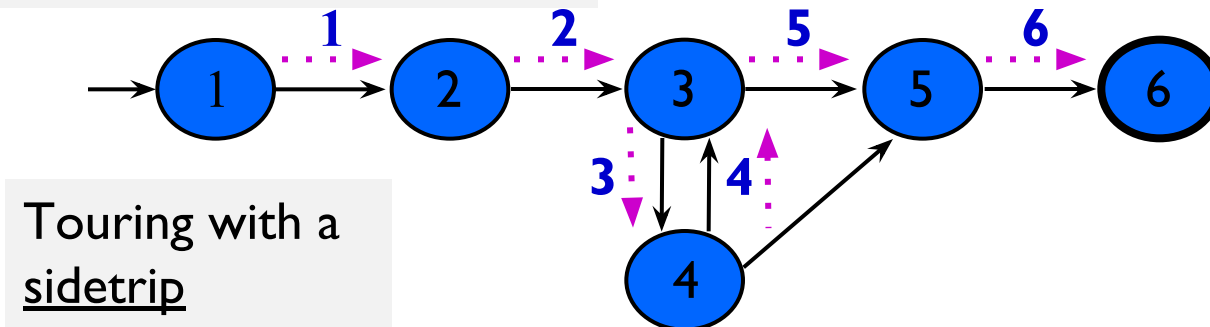
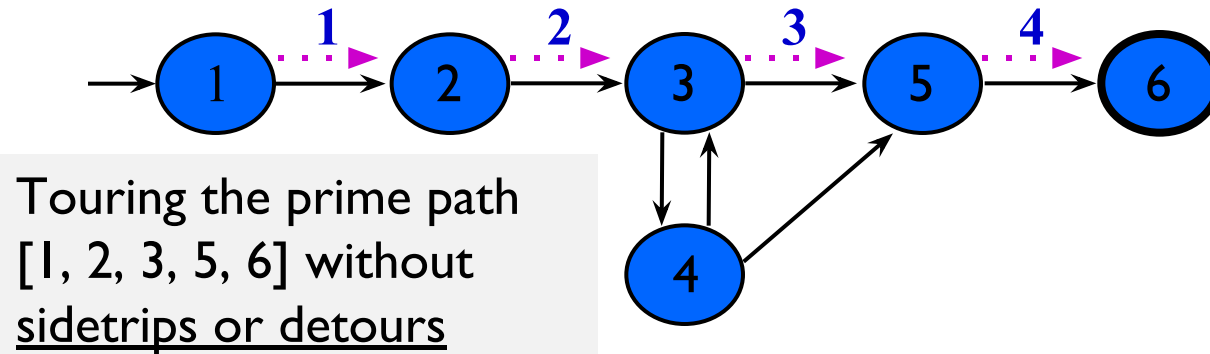
[1, 2, 3, 5, 7] !

*Prime Paths ?*

# Touring, Sidetrips, and Detours

- Prime paths do not have **internal loops** ... test paths might
- **Tour** : *A test path  $p$  tours subpath  $q$  if  $q$  is a subpath of  $p$*
- **Tour With Sidetrips** : *A test path  $p$  tours subpath  $q$  with sidetrips iff every edge in  $q$  is also in  $p$  in the same order*
  - The tour can include a sidetrip, as long as it comes back to the same node
- **Tour With Detours** : *A test path  $p$  tours subpath  $q$  with detours iff every node in  $q$  is also in  $p$  in the same order*
  - The tour can include a detour from node  $ni$ , as long as it comes back to the prime path at a successor of  $ni$

# Sidetrips and Detours Example



# Infeasible Test Requirements

- An **infeasible** test requirement cannot be satisfied
  - Unreachable statement (dead code)
  - Subpath that can only be executed with a contradiction ( $X > 0$  and  $X < 0$ )
- Most test **criteria** have some infeasible test requirements
- It is usually **undecidable** whether all test requirements are feasible
- When sidetrips are not allowed, many structural criteria have **more infeasible test requirements**
- However, always allowing **sidetrips weakens** the test criteria

## **Practical recommendation—Best Effort Touring**

- Satisfy as many test requirements as possible without sidetrips
- Allow sidetrips to try to satisfy remaining test requirements

# Round Trips

- **Round-Trip Path** : *A prime path that starts and ends at the same node*

**Simple Round Trip Coverage (SRTC)** : TR contains at least one round-trip path for each reachable node in **G** that begins and ends a round-trip path.

**Complete Round Trip Coverage (CRTC)** : TR contains all round-trip paths for each reachable node in **G**.

- These criteria omit nodes and edges that are not in round trips
- Thus, they do not subsume edge-pair, edge, or node coverage